The East-West corridor has been planned to connect Silchar in Assam with the port town of Porbandar in Gujarat with 3,640km of road length. The two corridors intersect at Jhansi.

h) Expressways

These are multi-lane good quality highways for high speed traffic. Some of the important expressways are; (i)Mumbai-Pune Road, (ii) Kolkata-Dumdum Airport road (iii) Durgapur-Kolkata road and (iv) Yamuna expressway between Delhi and Agra.



Mumbai-Pune Road

i) International Highways

These are the roads that link India with neighbouring countries for promoting harmonious relationship with them. These highways have been constructed with an aid from world bank under an agreement with the Economic and Social Commission for Asia-Pacific (ESCAP). These roads connect important highways of India with those of the neighbouring countries such as Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and Myanmar.

Railways

Indian railway system is the main artery of the country's inland transport. Railways cater to the needs of large scale movement of traffic, both for freight and passenger, thereby contributing to economic growth. Railways are considered as the backbone of the surface transport system of India. It promotes national integration by bringing people together. It also promotes trade, tourism, education etc. Railways help in the commercialization of the agriculture sector by facilitating the bulky movement of perishable goods. Its role in transporting raw materials to industries and finished goods to markets is invaluable. Indian railways network is the largest in Asia and second largest in the world.

For operations and management, the Indian Railways is organized into 17 zones.

S. No.	Zone	Headquarters
1.	Northern Railway	New Delhi
2.	North-Western Railway	Jaipur
3.	North-Central Railway	Allahabad
4.	North-Eastern Railway	Gorakhpur
5.	North-East Frontier Railway	Guwahati
6.	Eastern Railway	Kolkata
7.	East coast Railway	Bhubaneswar
8.	East-Central Railway	Hazipur
9.	West-Central Railway	Jabalpur
10.	Central Railway	Mumbai (VT)
11.	Western Railway	Mumbai (Churchgate)
12.	Southern Railway	Chennai
13.	South-Central Railway	Secunderabad
14.	South Eastern Railway	Kolkata
15.	South-Western Railway	Hubball
16.	South East Central Railway	Bilaspur
17.	Konkan Railway	Navi Mumbai

On the basis of width of the track, the Indian railways fall under four categories.

1. Broad gauge (1.676 meter width)
2. Meter gauge (1 meter width)
3. Narrow gauge (0.762 meter width)
4. Light gauge (0.610 meter width)

DO YOU KNOW?

- The first sub-urban railway was started in 1925 in Mumbai.
- Gatiman Express is the fastest operational train in India. This train connects New Delhi and Agra and touches 160 km/h.

a) Metro Railways in India

There are 8 cities with metro rail connectivity in India. They are Kolkata (West

15_Geography_Unit_5_EM.indd 192 11-04-2020 12:34:27